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CINNOVATE SOLUTIONS (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED

CIN : U62099RJ2025OPC100267

Department Wise Audit Report

Finance & Accounts

Costing, Compliance & Payables — Shobha Shekhawat

An independent operational review of the Finance & Accounts department, evaluating COGS volatility, GST reconciliation workloads, and cross-departmental data friction, prepared as part of the EF Polymer Private Limited organization-wide operational audit by Creative Upaay (brand owned by Cinnovate Solutions (OPC) Private Limited).

CLIENT	EF Polymer Private Limited
PREPARED BY	Creative Upaay
DOCUMENT VERSION	1.0
DATE ISSUED	18th July 2026
REVIEW SCOPE	Finance, Accounts, Costing & Reimbursement Operations



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SECTION 01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Department Overview

Scope, current state, and headline findings

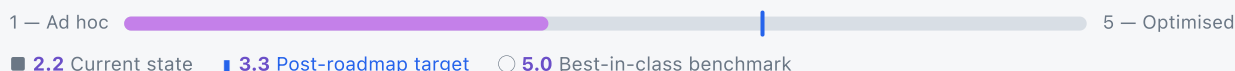
The Finance & Accounts team manages corporate bookkeeping, regulatory tax filing, cost accounting, and employee expense auditing. The core 3-person team relies heavily on the Zoho Suite, but encounters massive friction in cross-system data transfer and manual reconciliations.

The audit revealed a severe structural issue in cost accounting: COGS margins fluctuate wildly because the factory lacks an integrated inventory management system. Accounts cannot track Work-in-Progress (WIP) or grade-based costs, forcing manual spreadsheet reconciliations. Furthermore, the team spends 1–2 months manually reconciling 100+ GST/TDS entries against government portals, and lacks real-time stock visibility for invoicing, requiring manual phone calls to Production for every dispatch.

1–2 Mo MONTHLY TAX RECONCILIATION CYCLE	100+ GST/TDS CLAIMS RECONCILED	3 TEAM MEMBERS	2.2 / 5.0 OVERALL MATURITY SCORE
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About the Maturity Score

A 1–5 scale measuring how systematised, documented, and independently operable the department is. Scored across five dimensions: Process, Technology, Data Quality, Documentation & Knowledge Management.





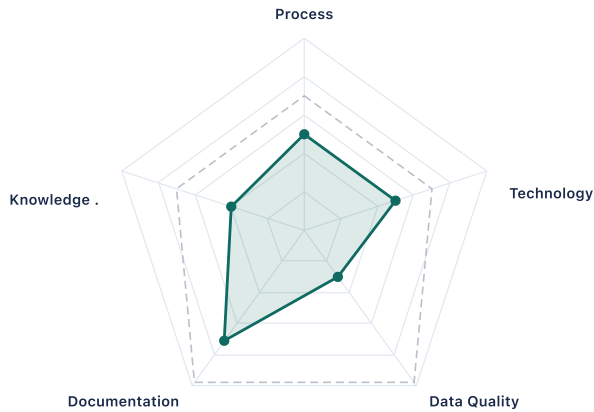
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SECTION 02 — BENCHMARKING

Department Maturity Assessment



Solid line: current state. Dashed line: target state (post-roadmap).

Finance & Accounts scores 2.2 overall — Highly standardized processes and tooling are severely degraded by poor Data Quality (Score: 1.5). The manual interventions required for COGS calculations and GST reconciliation negate the value of the Zoho platform.

Automating matching rules and implementing WIP logic will rapidly pull the department past the 3.0 target threshold.

DIMENSION	CURRENT	TARGET	GAP
Process Standardization	2.5	3.5	1.0
Technology Utilization	2.5	3.5	1.0
Data Quality & Accessibility	1.5	3.5	2.0
Documentation	2.5	3.5	1.0
Knowledge Management	2.0	2.5	0.5
Overall	2.2	3.3	1.1

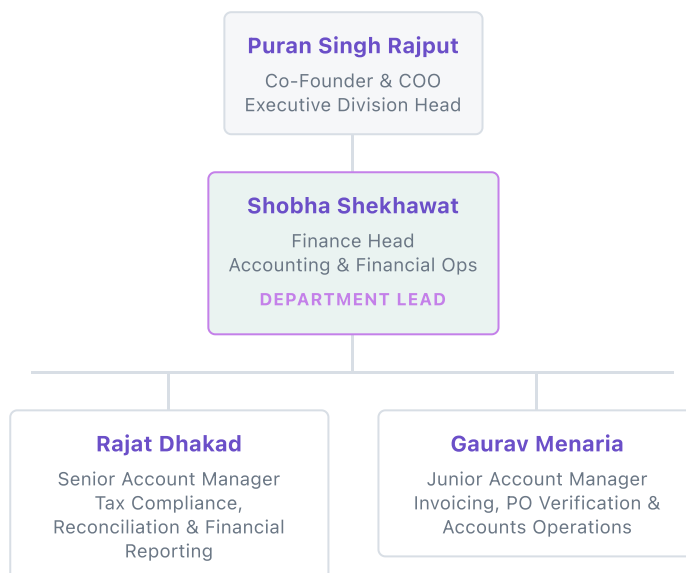


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Team Structure

Reporting hierarchy within Finance & Accounts, operating under Puran Singh Rajput (Co-Founder & COO).



Tools in Use



Zoho Books

Core accounting ledger, bank feeds, GST filing & invoicing. Lacks WIP visibility.



Zoho Expense

Employee reimbursements & mileage tracking. Requires manual odometer verification.



Zoho Payroll & People

Payroll processing, employee data management, and leave tracking.



Google Sheets

Manual COGS calculation, inventory tracking, and cross-department data reconciliation.



WhatsApp

Instant communication for field teams and unstructured data collection.



Slack

Communication tool used by the Accounts team to coordinate with international team members (not a finance system).



Google Drive

Storage for purchase invoices, vendor bills, & asset documentation. Lacks directory search.



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SECTION 03 — PROCESS DETAIL

Current Workflows

Where each finding sits inside the operational process

Order Billing & Dispatch Invoicing — P-03



What is good: The sequence from PO receipt to invoicing is clearly defined and strictly enforced by the Accounts team.

What needs to be fixed: A blind spot in Zoho Inventory breaks the digital flow, forcing Accounts back to phone calls to ensure physical stock is available before raising the invoice.

Bottlenecks: Manual phone verification with Production creates an invoicing bottleneck and prevents seamless order dispatch.

Dependencies: Accounts is entirely reliant on Production for real-time stock updates and Sales for correct GST details.

Inventory Valuation & Costing — P-01



What is good: The team strictly follows the FIFO (First-In, First-Out) method to calculate raw material exit costs.

What needs to be fixed: Due to a lack of grade-based tracking and unamortized packaging expenses, the final recorded COGS swings violently, preventing accurate P&L forecasting.

Bottlenecks: Zoho Books cannot natively track the 3 states of raw material (Unprocessed, WIP, Ready). This requires manual spreadsheet intervention that takes 15% of the team's time.

Dependencies: Accounts is dependent on Production for WIP volume data and Logistics for transit/in-transit stock data.

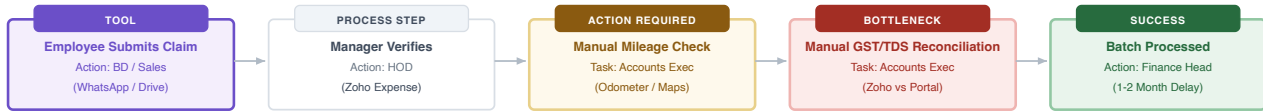


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Expense Reimbursement & Reconciliation — P-02



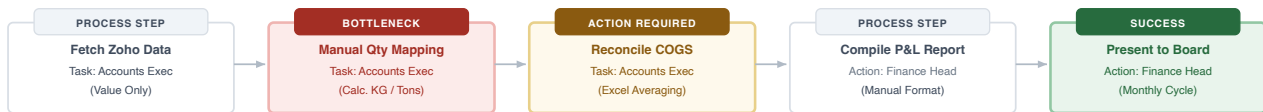
What is good: A strict 2-level managerial approval ensures business purpose validation before expenses hit the ledger.

What needs to be fixed: Without system access for field workers, claims flow through WhatsApp, forcing managers into manual distance-checks. 100+ monthly claims take 1-2 months to reconcile against government portals.

Bottlenecks: Checking odometer readings and matching GST/TDS invoices against portal data is a massive manual time sink.

Dependencies: Accounts is dependent on Sales/BD for clear bill photographs and manual text entries of distances traveled.

Monthly CXO & Investor Reporting — P-06



What is good: The team maintains a rigorous monthly schedule for P&L and expense reporting to CXOs and investors.

What needs to be fixed: Zoho Books only reports sales by value, not by tonnage/SKUs. Accounts must manually map item counts to weights and compile it in Excel.

Bottlenecks: No real-time visibility exists. Leadership cannot track budget vs. actual expenses or target sales vs. achieved sales until the month-end report is generated.

Dependencies: Complete P&L reporting depends on the delayed reconciliation of COGS and expense claims.



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APPENDIX

Cross-Department Dependencies

Findings and recommendations that require action outside the Finance Office to resolve

Sales & Business Development

COMMERCIAL SUPPORT

OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

Sales submits POs to Accounts but frequently lacks complete GST and billing details. Accounts must manually chase Sales for client documentation before invoicing.

 **Key Person:** Ankit Jain (CBDO / Sales Head)

CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

Unstructured expense submissions via WhatsApp and incomplete client data delay the order-to-cash cycle and tax reconciliation.

DATA TRANSFER & UPDATES NEEDED

Sales must adopt a standardized intake format for client GST/Address data before requesting invoices. Field staff must transition to the Zoho Expense app for automated mileage capture and bill uploads.

Production & Logistics

OPERATIONAL HANDOFF

OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

Accounts relies on Production for real-time stock availability and WIP data, and Logistics for transit/dispatch status. Currently, this data is shared manually via phone calls or WhatsApp.

 **Key Persons:** Rishabh Doshi (Production) / Nihal Paliwal (Logistics)

CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

No shared inventory system exists. Accounts cannot value WIP accurately, causing 50-77% COGS margin swings and invoicing delays.

DATA TRANSFER & UPDATES NEEDED

Production and Logistics must update their Google Sheets (or a unified tracker) with grade-wise WIP, transit, and dispatch data. Accounts will connect to this sheet via API to automate COGS valuation and stock checks.



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CXO & Investor Visibility

STRATEGIC REPORTING

OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

CXOs and investors require monthly P&L, sales achievements, and budget utilization reports. Currently compiled manually at month-end.

 **Key Person: Shobha Shekhawat (Finance Head)**

CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

No real-time visibility into budget vs. spend or target vs. achieved sales. Decision-making is delayed by 30 days.

DATA TRANSFER & UPDATES NEEDED

A unified dashboard must be built to pull live data from Zoho Books, Payroll, and Expense, giving CXOs real-time access to financial metrics without manual compilation.



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SECTION 04 — OPERATIONAL PAIN POINTS

Pain Points Register

Ranked by operational impact. Each pain point is cross-referenced to its recommendation in Section 06.

Priority Focus Areas:

- ① **Manual Tax & Expense Reconciliation** — 100+ monthly claims and GST/TDS matching against government portals takes 1-2 months, consuming ~10% of team capacity during peak cycles.
- ② **COGS Volatility & WIP Blind Spots** — Lack of grade-based inventory tracking and WIP valuation distorts P&L margins and forces manual spreadsheet calculations.

	PAIN POINT	IMPACT	EVIDENCE FROM AUDIT	SOLUTION REF
P-01	Untraceable COGS Margin Volatility. COGS margins swing wildly because Zoho Inventory cannot value Work-in-Progress (WIP) or grade-based costs.	CRITICAL	Executive leadership cannot rely on the P&L margin logic; distorts profitability and investor reporting.	Module 2
P-02	Manual Tax Compliance & Expense Load. Reconciling government GST/TDS portals against Zoho Books for 100+ claims takes 1–2 months of manual labor.	CRITICAL	Burns ~10% of the team's monthly capacity on non-strategic data entry and manual odometer checks.	Module 2
P-03	Lack of Real-time Stock Visibility. Accounts cannot check stock levels before invoicing, requiring manual phone calls to Production.	CRITICAL	Creates an invoicing bottleneck; prevents seamless order dispatch and delays the sales cycle.	Module 1
P-04	Manual Sales Quantity Compilation. Zoho Books reports sales by value, not by tonnage/SKUs.	HIGH	Accounts must download and manually compile volume metrics in Excel to calculate raw material exit costs.	Module 1
P-05	Manual Fixed Asset & Depreciation Tracking. Depreciation for machinery and assets is calculated entirely manually outside the system.	HIGH	Increases risk of calculation errors and requires manual journal entries into Zoho Books.	Module 3



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P-06 **No Real-time CXO & Investor Visibility.** Monthly P&L and budget reporting is compiled manually at month-end.

HIGH

Leadership cannot track budget vs. actual expenses or target sales vs. achieved sales in real-time.

**Module
1**

P-07 **Fragmented Vendor & Client Directory.** GST and billing details are collected over WhatsApp/Email and stored in isolated Sheets.

MEDIUM

Requires repetitive master data checking when raising invoices, especially for repeat orders.

**Module
3**



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SECTION 05 — TIME & EFFORT

Time & Effort Allocation

Based on a standard 8-hour workday. Hours shown are estimates per team member per day, averaged across the team.

ACTIVITY	SHARE OF TEAM TIME	EST. TIME / DAY
GST/TDS Regulatory Reconciliation & Expense Auditing (peak cycle load)	~10%	~0.8 hrs
COGS Valuation & Manual Spreadsheet Reporting	~30%	~2.4 hrs
Bank Reconciliation & Inbound Matching	~25%	~2.0 hrs
Invoicing, PO Checks & Master Data Validation	~25%	~2.0 hrs
Travel Expense & Odometer Verification	~10%	~48 min



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SECTION 06 — CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN

Recommended Solution Segment

This section outlines the integrated technology solution proposed to resolve operational bottlenecks, replacing the legacy recommendations register.

Implementation Required

Solution Modules to be Built:

1

Accounts Frontend Dashboard P-03

P-04 P-06

- **Real-Time Stock & WIP Sync:** Connects directly to Production & Logistics Google Sheets. Accounts gets live visibility of raw material states (Unprocessed, WIP, Ready, Transit) without phone calls.
- **Unified CXO View:** Integrates Zoho Books, Expense, and Payroll into one dashboard. Gives CXOs real-time P&L, budget vs. actuals, and target vs. achieved sales.
- **Automated Tonnage Calc:** Custom logic layer that maps Zoho item counts to KGs/MTs, eliminating manual Excel compilation.

2

AI & Reconciliation Systems P-01

P-02

- **GST/TDS Recon Bot:** An AI agent that reads Zoho Books data and government portal exports, automatically flagging mismatches and red-flagging non-reconciled entries. *Crucially, the bot surfaces red-flag mismatches within a few hours, which helps the team complete the full reconciliation in just a few days rather than 1–2 months.*
- **Smart Bill Scanner:** AI layer that ingests WhatsApp/Drive bill images, extracts vendor/GST/amount data, and auto-populates the directory and Zoho Expense.

3

Automated Comms & Directory P-05 P-07

- **Vendor & Client MDM:** A central directory storing GST, addresses, and billing details. Reusable for repeat orders.
- **WhatsApp API Alerts:** Automated notifications to Sales/Logistics when invoices are cleared, and automated reminders to Prod for WIP updates.

- **GST/TDS Reconciliation Bot:** An AI agent that reads Zoho Books data and government portal exports, automatically flagging mismatches and red-flagging non-reconciled entries. *Crucially, this reduces a 1-2 month process into a few hours of reviewing exceptions.*
- **Smart Bill Scanner:** AI layer that ingests WhatsApp/Drive bill images, extracts vendor/GST/amount data, and auto-populates the directory and Zoho Expense.



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What Remains the Same

- **No New Backend Database:** Zoho Books/Expense remain the core ledger. Production keeps using Google Sheets.
- **Familiar Workflows:** Field staff can still submit via WhatsApp; the AI handles the structuring.

Tech Stack Utilized

- **Frontend:** ReactJS + TypeScript
- **APIs:** Google Sheets, Zoho Books/Expense, WhatsApp
- **AI:** Gemini/LLMs for Recon & OCR extraction
- **Host:** Google Cloud Platform

Key Operational Problems Solved

- Eliminates 1-2 months of manual GST/TDS reconciliation via AI exception flagging.
- Resolves the COGS volatility by providing live WIP visibility from Production.
- Removes manual phone calls for stock checks and accelerates the invoicing cycle.
- Provides CXOs and investors with real-time financial visibility without manual month-end compilation.

Future Scope of Improvement / Enhancement

- **Automated Asset Register:** In the future, an AI agent could be added to actively track machinery depreciation and auto-post journal entries to Zoho Books based on invoice scans. This is not needed right now but is a planned future enhancement.

Next Steps for Team Adoption

- **Mandatory Training:** Team adoption and training sessions must be made compulsory to ensure all team members understand how to use the dashboard and AI tools.
- **Feedback Loop:** Establish a continuous feedback loop to iterate on the solution on the ground, ensuring it genuinely adapts to the team's operational reality and achieves actual adoption.



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SECTION 07 — IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Phased Roadmap

Initiatives sequenced across three phases, with quantified ROI and scope of work

INITIATIVE		PHASE 1 WEEKS 1–4	PHASE 2 WEEKS 5–9	PHASE 3 WEEKS 10–12
Accounts Frontend Dashboard & API Sync	Module 1	●		
AI Recon Bot & Smart Bill Scanner	Module 2		●	
Automated Comms & Directory MDM	Module 3			●

Phase 1 — Core Infrastructure & Dashboard

Weeks 1–4 · Centralizing Data & Workflows

Maturity 2.2 → 2.7

SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Connect Production/Logistics Google Sheets to a new ReactJS Dashboard for real-time WIP & stock visibility.
- **Build:** Implement unified CXO P&L view by connecting Zoho Books & Expense APIs.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** React.js Dashboard Google Sheets API Zoho Suite APIs .
- **Team Adoption:** Conduct initial walkthrough sessions for the Accounts team to navigate the new UI.
- **Client To-Do:** Provide read/write API access to Zoho Suite, **standardise Zoho Books tagging** (region, client, expense category) — this is the data-quality gate for every downstream dashboard — and map the exact calculation logic for tonnage mapping.

O

PHONE CALLS

Eliminates manual stock checks with Production.

Live

CXO VISIBILITY

Real-time P&L and budget tracking.

Auto

TONNAGE CALC

Eliminates manual Excel compilation for volume metrics.



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Phase 2 — AI & Reconciliation Systems

Weeks 5–9 · Automating Compliance

Maturity 2.7 → 3.0

SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Deploy GST/TDS Recon Bot to compare Zoho data against portal exports and flag mismatches.
- **Build:** Smart Bill Scanner AI that reads WhatsApp/Drive images and auto-populates Zoho Expense & Vendor Directory.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** Gemini LLMs , OCR API , WhatsApp Business API .
- **Team Adoption:** Train field staff to submit bills via the designated WhatsApp bot number.
- **Client To-Do:** Provide historical GST recon sheets and sample vendor invoices to train the AI.

↓ 40%

RECON TIME

Bot flags red-flags in hours; full recon completes in days, not 1–2 months.

Zero

MANUAL ENTRY

Bill data auto-extracted and populated.

Unified

TOOLING

AI tools live inside the dashboard; no app-jumping.

Phase 3 — Automated Comms & Directory

Weeks 10–12 · Scaling Visibility & Reminders

Maturity 3.0 → 3.3

SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Establish central Vendor/Client MDM with mandatory GST/Address gates before invoice requests.
- **Build:** Integrate WhatsApp API for automated alerts to Sales/Logistics when invoices are cleared.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** WhatsApp Business API , React.js MDM .
- **Team Adoption:** Establish a continuous feedback loop on the ground to iterate and sustain adoption.
- **Client To-Do:** Provide individual team member roadmaps, platform preferences, and contact details for API mapping.

100%

DATA FIDELITY

No repeat GST verification loops with Sales.

Instant

COMMS

Automated invoice clearance alerts.

Sustained

USAGE

Feedback loop ensures the solution adapts to reality.



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System Impact: Before & After

Measurable improvements post-implementation

CATEGORY	BEFORE (CURRENT STATE)	AFTER (POST-IMPLEMENTATION)
Stock & WIP Visibility	Manual phone calls to Production; WIP values unknown.	Live Dashboard Sync. Real-time API connection to Production Sheets shows all 3 material states.
GST/TDS Reconciliation	1-2 months of manual matching against government portals for 100+ claims.	AI Exception Flagging. Bot flags red flags in hours; full reconciliation completes in days.
COGS Valuation	Volatile margins (50-77% swings); manual Excel averaging.	Stable P&L. Automated WIP & packaging amortization logic yields consistent margins.
Expense Submissions	WhatsApp images; manual odometer checks; manual Zoho entry.	AI Bill Scanner. Ingests WhatsApp images, extracts data, auto-populates Zoho Expense.
Executive Reporting	Manual month-end compilation; no real-time budget tracking.	Real-Time Dashboard. CXOs & investors view live P&L, budget vs. actuals, and sales targets.
Vendor & Client Data	Scattered across Google Drive & Sheets; repetitive requests to Sales.	Central MDM. Reusable directory with mandatory GST gates before invoice generation.
Department Maturity Score	2.2 / 5.0 (Ad-hoc)	3.3 / 5.0 (Systematised)



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Quantified Executive Time Savings

Estimated annual bandwidth reclaimed for the Finance & Accounts Head (Shobha Shekhawat & team) by automating GST/TDS recon and expense bill processing.

~40% RECON TIME SAVED	100% AUTO BILL EXTRACTION	25 hrs MONTHLY TIME SAVED	300 hrs ANNUAL HOURS SAVED
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Bandwidth Reinvestment Breakdown:

- **Current Friction:** Finance team spends 1–2 months manually reconciling GST/TDS portal exports and manually typing WhatsApp expense images into Zoho Books.
- **Automated Efficiency:** AI Recon Bot flags only exception mismatches and Smart Bill Scanner ingests images to auto-populate Zoho Expense instantly.
- **Strategic Impact:** Reclaims **300 Finance hours per year (~37.5 full working days)** to focus on tax optimization, strategic financial forecasting, and investor P&L reporting.